



Individual Instructor Report Spring 2025 Version A for STA 235 - DATA SCI FOR BUSINESS APPLCTNS (05550) (Henrique Bolfarine)

Project Title: **Course Evaluations Spring 2025**

Courses Audience: **55**

Responses Received: **49**

Response Ratio: **89.1%**

Report Comments

Guide to the Interpretation of Course Evaluations at UT Austin

The goal of course evaluation process at UT Austin is to drive teaching excellence and to support continuous improvement in teaching and learning experiences. The two sets of scales used for core evaluation questions and the associated weights are:

Strongly Agree (5)
Agree (4)
Neutral (3)
Disagree (2)
Strongly Disagree (1)

Excellent (5)
Very Good (4)
Satisfactory (3)
Unsatisfactory (2)
Very Unsatisfactory (1)

The Mean is calculated by adding all of the weights for a single question and dividing by the number of respondents. The course workload question is not averaged.

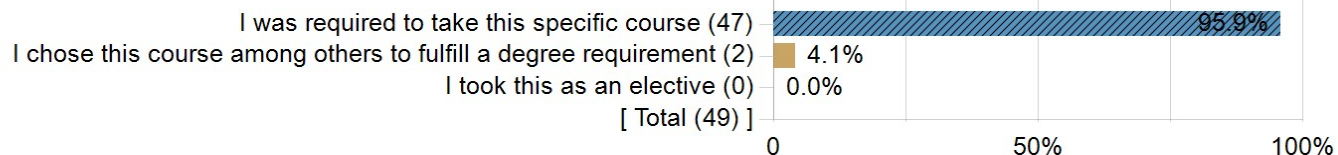
The number of students (e.g. respondents) marking each option is reported for each of the items. These frequency distributions provide information about the level of student ratings and the spread and shape of the class distribution of responses. The distributions thus provide a picture of student perception of a course.

Course evaluations provide snapshots of student perspectives on their course-level learning experiences. Most experts on teaching evaluation advise that no individual method gives the complete picture of an instructor's teaching effectiveness; multiple and diverse measures, on multiple occasions, are advised to give a full picture of the teaching effectiveness of a particular instructor. Moreover, other factors, such as size of class, level of the class, and content of the course, can cause small variations in the ratings. Therefore, student perspectives for a particular instructor or course should be interpreted as a snapshot, and not as providing complete information on the teaching effectiveness of that instructor.

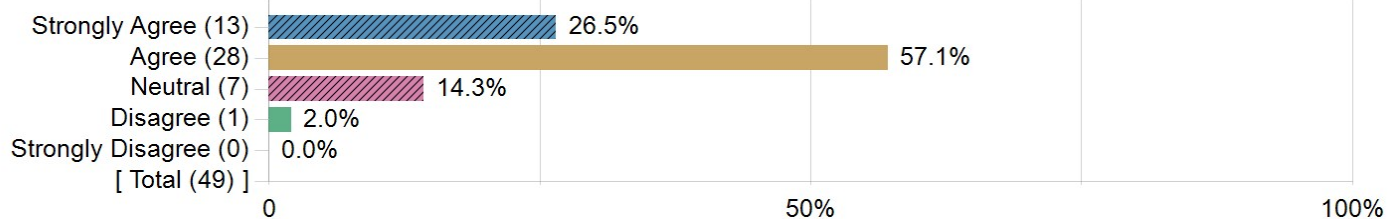
Creation Date: **Friday, May 9, 2025**

Course Questions

Why did you take this course?



During this course, I gained a deeper understanding of the subject matter.



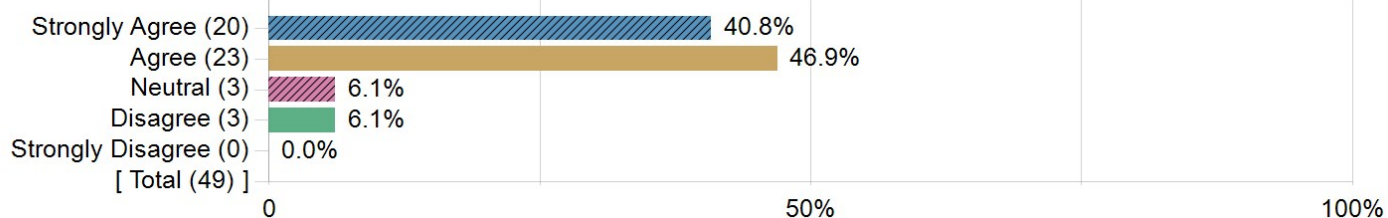
Statistics

Value

Mean

4.08

The course was well organized.



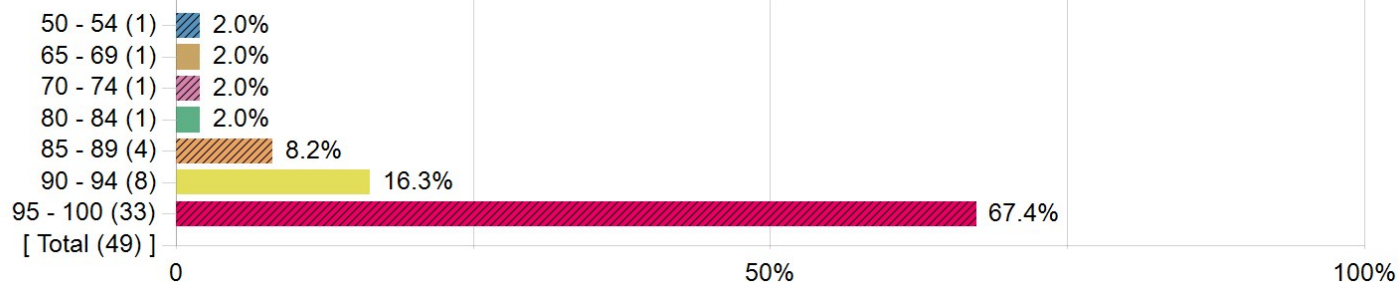
Statistics

Value

Mean

4.22

Overall, approximately what percentage of the course meetings did you attend or complete (online, in person, or asynchronously)?



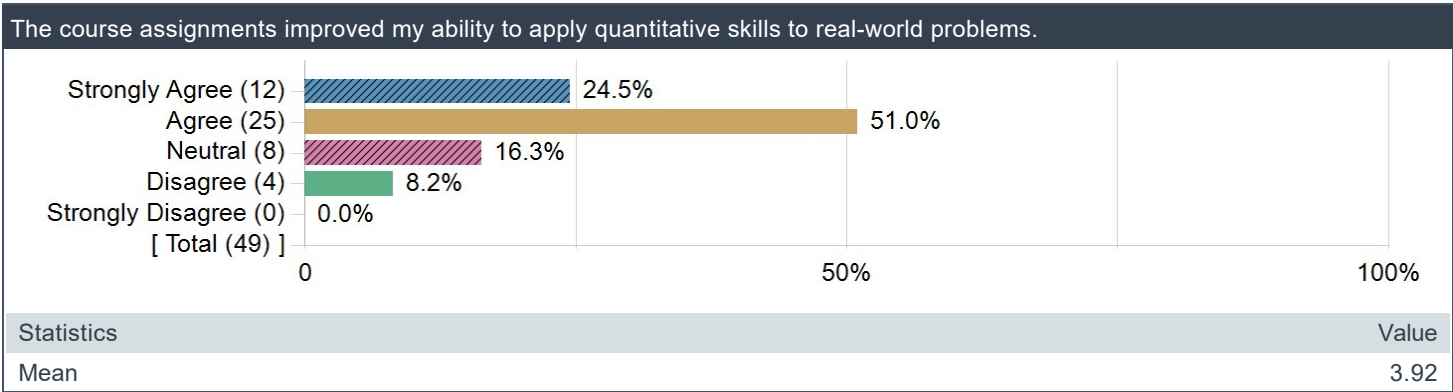
Statistics

Value

Mean

93.98

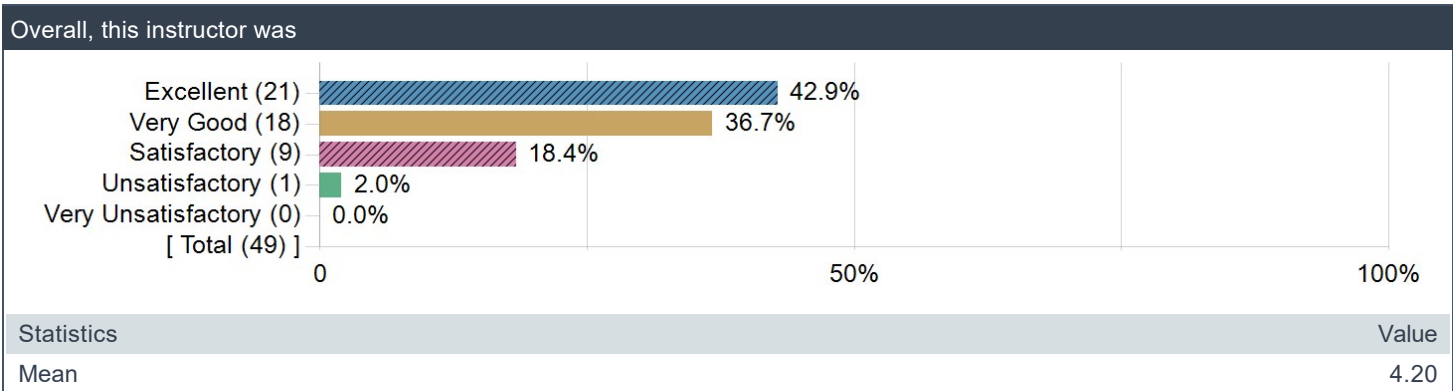
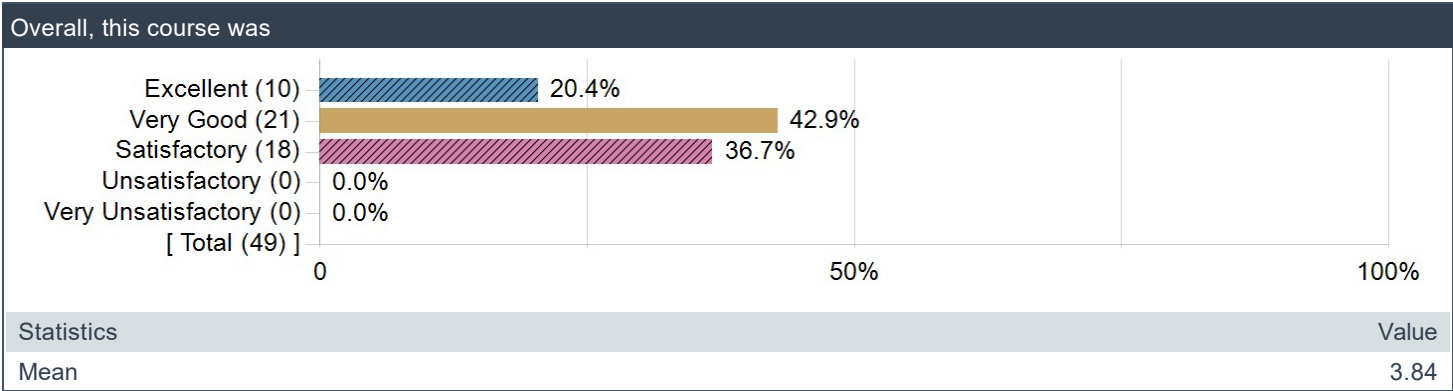
The course assignments improved my ability to apply quantitative skills to real-world problems. (Flag Question)



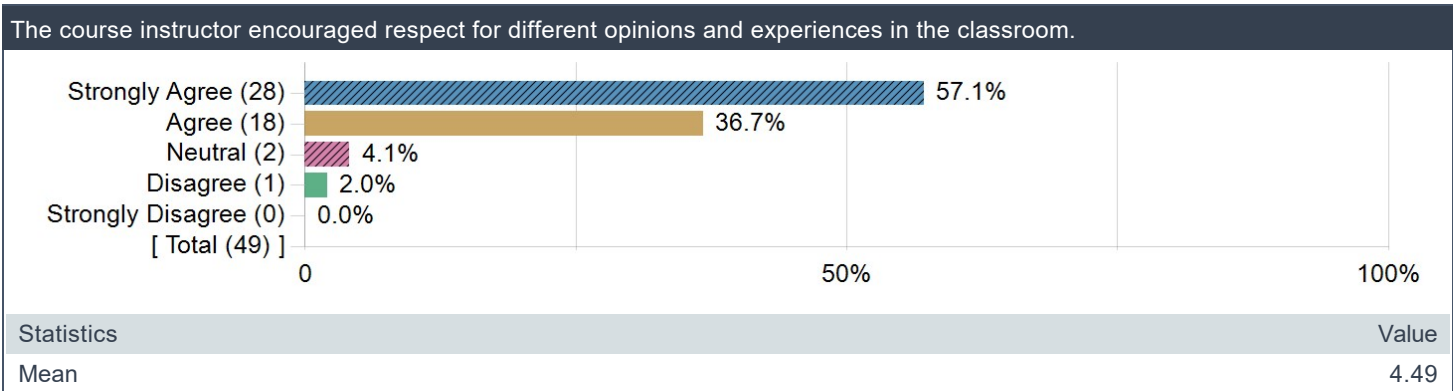
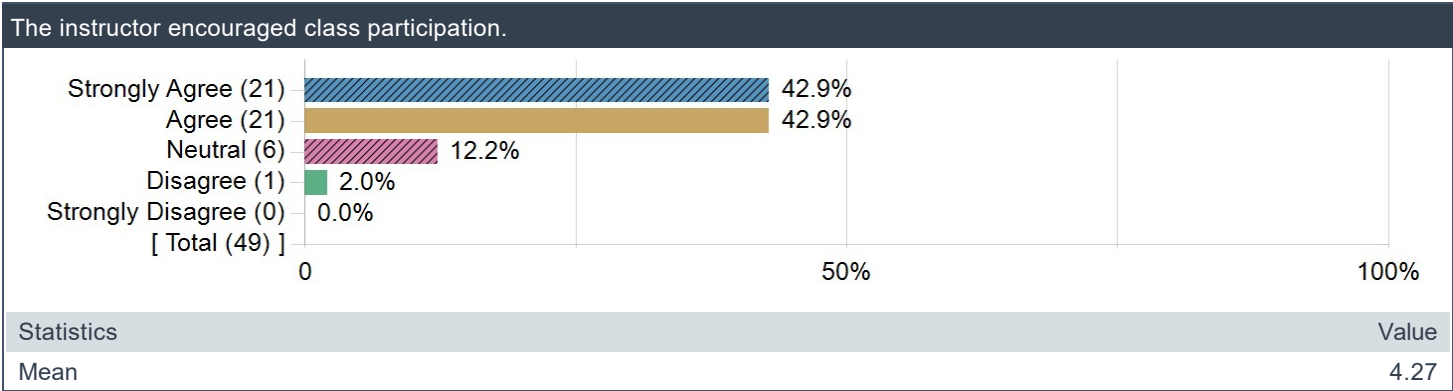
Instructor Questions

	Strongly Agree	Agree	Neutral	Disagree	Strongly Disagree	Responded	Mean
The instructor clearly explained the course objectives and expectations.	42.9%	49.0%	8.2%	0.0%	0.0%	49	4.35
The instructor fostered an inclusive learning environment.	59.2%	32.7%	6.1%	2.0%	0.0%	49	4.49
The instructor effectively explained the concepts and subject matter in this course.	40.8%	42.9%	10.2%	6.1%	0.0%	49	4.18
The instructional techniques kept me engaged in learning.	34.7%	28.6%	24.5%	8.2%	4.1%	49	3.82
The instructor checked for student understanding of the concepts presented in the course.	51.0%	42.9%	6.1%	0.0%	0.0%	49	4.45

Overall Questions



College, School, or Unit Questions



Comment Questions

Identify aspects of the course that were the most effective in helping your learning.

Comments
n/a
Learning how to analyze R Studio Data
He really enjoys talking about this subject, which makes it easy to follow along with him. His class is also well organized.
Thee most effective aspect of the course for my learning was probably the homework. I went through each homework before the test and did well. Also, the quiz helped me with my critical thinking.
The in class quizzes and homeworks
Amazing instructor. Very helpful in office hours and committed to making sure students understand the material.
What was helpful is the professor showing us what each code means and it helped a lot on the homeworks
The homeworks were the most helpful in forming my understanding of the concepts.
the assigned homeworks and sample exams were the most effective.
Having the lectures recorded is such a good way to review content you might have missed. Adding on, having mutiple practice exams helps a lot too.
The course assignments provided ample practice, and the instructor lectured very well.
I think the structure of the course was most effective for my learning in this class. Each class was followed up with a homework assignment and a quiz to reinforce learning. Expectations and the flow of the class were very clear and standardized across sections. I also really appreciated that the tests for this class were paper and pencil format this semester. I had heard of lots of cheating problems in this class in prior semesters, so this format of testing encouraged me and reinforced the idea that if I gave my best, that work would be reinforced with my grade, and that others would be on an even playing field. I appreciate that Professor Bolfarine made a recording of doing a practice exam and explained concepts in depth in this video. That was very helpful. He was also overall very friendly and approachable, and willing to help.
The homeworks
The lectures were engaging, and practice exams were helpful for the in-person, on-paper tests.
Dr. Bolfarine is a witty, engaging professor who makes lectures and a difficult topic easier to intake.
Pre class quizzes
The slide shows
the homeworks were very helpful to further my knowledge about what we learned in class.
The homeworks, in-class quizzes, and practice tests helped me gain a deeper understanding of the material I needed to know.
What helped is the practice exam and the how to video on how to do go about the exam.
Homeworks were very helpful
Learned how to code a little better
quizzes and HW
Homework
Review Sessions
I liked how the professor followed along with the students.
I think he was very knowledgeable of the material, which helped difficult topics become easier to learn.
recordings
I enjoyed prof Bolfarine's humor
I found the homeworks to be incredibly helpful in assisting my learning.
Bolfarine is a great and kind hearted professor. He does a good job at explaining concepts and walking through things at a good pace.
The in-class work through problems and PowerPoint were easy to follow, allowing me to understand what was being taught. Also things being recorded helped when i wanted to go back to refresh my memory on some new topics.
the homework assignments
in class R practice
Going through R code together in class

Identify the aspect of the course that you found most challenging, why you found it was challenging, and suggest one thing that could be done to help future students meet that challenge more effectively.

Comments
n/a
Coding in R Studio
I would say the most challenging thing was the exams.
I think the aspect most difficult was the 2 hour long periods. I found that I would often zone out about an hour or hour and a half within the class time.
The course lecture didn't always line up well with what was on the homeworks and quizzes
Anything that was challenging in this course had resources such as the review sessions and TA office hours.
The quizzes were a bit hard because the homeworks were so different from the quizzes
It was challenging to spend a majority of class time in R Studio but then have only paper exams. The beginning of each class was helpful in the sense that we spent time going over conceptuels, so maybe a greater emphasis on that.
the in class quizzes were the most challenging because of the time limit and higher level of difficulty. one thing that can be done differently in the future is providing sample quizzes for each week.
Why should the quizzes be locked with a password.
Changing the test to a paper format initially threw me off.
I felt like each class started very slowly (pace-wise), and then the last 20 minutes or so were a rush to finish. As such, it was hard to stay attentive throughout the class, and whenever topics weren't finished in class, the professor would often film a video covering undiscussed content. This would seem fair, however, the videos were unnecessarily long and unrealistic to watch outside of class. Rather than spending the first 20 minutes of class previewing the class, I think it would be best to dive right in and stay at a steady pace. Preferably, all content would be covered in class, and if not, the outside-of-class videos should be short (around 20 minutes to keep attention).
The lectures were very confusing and the lecture slides were very dull, not able to use them to study at all.
The concepts were difficult and the homework was more difficult than what was explained in-class.
Dr. Bolfarine should post the quizzes afterwards so we can study them for tests.
The quizzes were difficult, but helpful. I wouldn't change it.
the most challenging part for me was the in class quizzes but did help me a ton for the midterm.
I found it was challenging when not all material was covered in class. I recommend restructuring the course so that the professor can have time to answer questions and get to everything needed to cover the material.
What has been challenging are the quizzes that are taken place in every class. I would suggest dropping the future student lowest quiz grade.
The in-class quizzes were really challenging
R studio and grasping the material completely.
second half of the semester
In-class quizzes: making the homework more applicable to the quizzes Learning: Class was too short to discuss a few topics, so the professor provided long walkthrough videos to supplement the missing material. This was frustrating, though, because the videos would be hours long and would make you question why there's only one class a week, and why the in-class lectures are redundant. I'm still glad I took this class because he's an amazing professor, but the lack of class time made things more complicated.
I think it is hard to follow along when we are learning to code for the entire two hours, yet the exams have no code to do, and it is just interpretation.
I think there was simply too much material for this to be a 2 hour class, once a week. I think this needs to be a 3 hour class, allowing for a more spaced-out and interactive classroom.
I just wasn't bought in to learning the content
I found the content of the class to be the most challenging at times. To help future students, I think it would be helpful to provide more opportunities to practice.
One thing that was challenging was coding in class but not using the coding on exams. It made me feel like we didn't need to actually learn the coding,
It was hard to stay engaged for the full 2 hours every week because it just felt like a lecture and not much active learning.
the in class quizzes
no breaks during class – it was hard to keep focus for 2 hours straight with no break

Comments
Homework that were different that material covered in class